

Peer-Review Report

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Edited by: Rickard Carlsson

Peer-Review Report of:

Peer Review Report of Submission MP2018.880 by
Imhoff & Messer

Final Decision: ACCEPTED

Lee Jussim

Rutgers University, USA

Åse Innes-Ker

Lund University, Sweden

Ulrich Schimmack

University of Toronto, Canada

Tobias Mühlmeister

Linnaeus University, Sweden

Rickard Carlsson

Linnaeus University, Sweden

On 2018-05-08, Roland Imhoff and Mario Messer submitted a manuscript (MP2018.880) to *Meta-Psychology*. I (Rickard Carlsson) assigned myself as action editor. The full unedited editorial history can be found at the OSF project page at <https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/Z6SDM>. Here follows a short summary of it.

The submission was a file-drawer report detailing 8 failed studies following up on a published finding by the first author (Imhoff and Banse, 2009). As they stated in the introduction of their submitted manuscript, their original paper finding was that “Reminding German participants of ongoing Jewish suffering led to an increase in antisemitism (compared to baseline), but only if they felt that untruthful (but socially desirable) responding was futile as we would detect such lies.”, and that this file-drawer was “the tale of a long series of (mostly conceptual) non-replications”.

File-drawer reports is a new format in Meta-Psychology where authors can completely empty their file-drawers on a topic. The main point of this type of article is to reduce publication bias and to learn as much as possible from studies that traditionally have been considered failures. Because this is a new format, Imhoff and I had some informal back-and forth on how to write this type of paper. In particular, I encouraged framing the studies in a “Meta” framework, putting the studies into a research program context, rather than

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writing the usual “story” of how they fit together.

I invited Åse Innes-Ker from the editorial board and Lee Jussim as an external reviewer. I also circulated it on social media where Ulrich Schimmack commented on it. All three reviewers were very positive of the paper. Whereas Jussim enjoyed the narrative style of the paper, Innes-Ker found room for improvement to prevent it from reading too much like a blog post, and that it could be streamlined. Other important points were raised, particularly about getting a better overview of their finding through an internal meta-analysis. I invited the authors to revise their manuscript.

Reading their revision, I felt confident deciding without sending it out for another round of review. In my final decision letter of their revision, I wrote that they did a good job of streamlining the paper and including an internal meta-analysis. I also noted that they had not followed all suggestions by the reviewers, but that they had done a good job explaining their rationale for not doing so in their response letter. I accepted it for publication concluding that it would make an excellent inaugural file-drawer paper.

Author contributions

Lee Jussim, Åse Innes-Ker, Ulrich Schimmack reviewed the submission. Rickard Carlsson edited the submission and summarized the editorial process into this report. Editorial assistant Tobias Mühlmeister checked the statistical analyses and found that they could be reproduced after some very minor clarifications. Authors are listed in random order with editor last.

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